

New guidelines to implement off-grid solar power plants scheme

The ministry of new and renewable energy (MNRE) has introduced new guidelines for the implementation of off-grid solar power plants under RESCO and PPA mode. It is in reference to the ministry's earlier order, where it had extended the off-grid and decentralised solar photovoltaic (PV) applications programme phase-III till 31st March 2021.

As per the guidelines, off-grid solar power plants of individual size up to 25kW can be installed in areas where grid power has not reached or is not reliable under phase-III of the programme. The scheme applies only to the northeastern states for the installation of off-grid solar PV plants through RESCO mode with central financial assistance (CFA) of 90 per cent of the benchmark cost of the system.

Under RESCO model, MNRE has proposed that the vendor would install and operate the solar power plant of capacity up to 10kWp for at least ten years and solar PV plants of capacity above 10kWp for at least fifteen years.

Government planning on import tax on lithium-ion cells

As per a report by *Livemint*, India plans to impose tariffs on imports of lithium-ion cells for as long as a decade. The report also says that the country plans to offer incentives to boost local manufacturing as part of the effort to reduce trade ties with China.

The report adds that the Indian government has taken note of China's dominance in this space. There are geopolitical reasons too behind devising such an incentive scheme for lithium cells.

As per the report, the government plans to offer incentives such as a hundred per cent tax deduction of capital expenditure in the first year of operation under section 35 AD, concessional financing options by giving companies deemed infrastructure status and waiver of minimum alternative tax. The report also

Calendar of Forthcoming Electronics Fairs/Exhibitions/Seminars/Events		
Event, Date and Venue	Topics	Contact address for details
IFA Berlin September 3-5, 2020 Exhibition Grounds Berlin Expo Center City, Messedamm 22, Berlin, Germany	Main meeting place for key retailers, buyers, and experts from the industry and the media	IFA Berlin Website: https://b2b.ifa-berlin.com
SEMICON Taiwan September 23-25, 2020 Taipei Nangang Exhibition Center, Hall 1 (TaiNEX 1)	The industry's first comprehensive physical-virtual event to gather industry leaders and visionaries for the latest developments, market trends and innovations in smart technologies	SEMICON Taiwan Website: www.semiexpo.expotec.tech/visitor/index
GITEX Technology Week September 27-October 1, 2020 Dubai World Trade Centre	World-class technology event. Technology leaders, enterprises and startups from around the world come together to show the future of every business and every industry	GITEX Website: www.gitex.com
OSI Days October 8-9, 2020 Nimhans Convention Centre, Bengaluru	Mega technology show with multiple events including expositions, conference and seminars	EFY Enterprises Pvt Ltd Website: www.opensourceindia.in
Engineering Design Show October 14-15, 2020 The Ricoh Arena, Coventry	UK's only event entirely dedicated to engineering, electronics and embedded design	Engineering Design Show Website: www.engineeringdesignshows.co.uk
3rd Automotive World October 21-23, 2020 Portmesse Nagoya, Japan	Exhibition and conference for advanced automotive technologies including electronics, smart factory and robotics	Reed Exhibitions Japan Ltd Website: www.automotiveworld-nagoya.jp
Light + LED Expo India 2020 December 3-5, 2020 Pragati Maidan, New Delhi	Will have Future Zone for innovative products, Solar Zone, and Launch Zone for new products	Messe Frankfurt Trade Fairs India Private Limited Website: www.in.messefrankfurt.com Email: deepak.bohara@india.messefrankfurt.com
CES 2021 January 6-9, 2021 Las Vegas, Nevada	Global consumer electronics show	Consumer Technology Association Website: www.ces.tech
NEPCON JAPAN January 20-22, 2021 Tokyo International Exhibition Center, Tokyo	Asia's leading electronics tech show about R&D and manufacturing, including packaging, with seven concurrent specialised shows	Reed Exhibitions Japan Ltd Website: www.nepconjapan.jp/en
India Electronics Week February 3-5, 2021 Karnataka Trade Promotion Organisation, Bengaluru	Mega electronics and technology show with multiple co-located events including expositions, conference and seminars	EFY Enterprises Pvt Ltd Website: www.indiaelectronicsweek.com
Since this information is subject to change, especially due to coronavirus breakout, all those interested are advised to ascertain the details from the organisers before making any commitment.		

says that there may be an output-linked cash subsidy based on kilowatt-hours (kWh) of cells sold. The ministry of heavy industry has been working on this proposal along with NITI Aayog. However, the Covid-19 pandemic can delay the introduction of the scheme.

Semiconductor manufacturing equipment market to reach \$ 95.9 billion by 2025

The global semiconductor manufacturing equipment market will grow to 95.9 billion dollars by 2025 from 62.4 billion dollars in 2020 at a CAGR of nine per cent, as per a report by MarketsandMarkets. The report says

that key factors that will drive this growth are increasing investments in R&D facilities due to Covid-19 impact and increasing demand for electric and hybrid vehicles.

It further adds that some other factors like growing consumer electronics market, the trend of miniaturisation and technology migration, and high demand for chips to provide computation power and connectivity for artificial intelligence (AI) applications are also pushing the growth.

The report further states that the memory segment of the semiconductor manufacturing equipment market, by product type, is projected to grow at a higher CAGR during the forecast period. New memory